



INTRO

CHAPTER CONTENTS.

📅 9 Oct 2025

What is causal mapping? What are its strengths and weaknesses?
How does a causal map differ from a systems diagram? This chapter has some answers.

PAGES IN THIS CHAPTER

- 📄 **Why causal mapping ?**
- 📄 **Causal mapping for outsiders**
- 📄 **Three ways to use causal mapping**
- 📄 **Mind mapping and causal mapping**
- 📄 **A causal map consists of multiple links where a link from X to Y means someone believes X influences Y**
- 📄 **Causal mapping helps make sense of many causal claims from many sources**
- 📄 **Causal mapping starts from what people actually say**
- 📄 **Causal mapping has been used for over 50 years in many disciplines**

- 📄 **Do use causal mapping when you have large numbers of claims from multiple sources, and more open research questions**
- 📄 **Do not use causal mapping if you have limited data or want precise models or specific causal links**
- 📄 **Causal mapping approaches differ in application, construction, analysis and how they deal with multiple sources**
- 📄 **Causal mappers believe that humans are good at thinking in terms of causal nuggets**
- 📄 **Causal mappers believe that humans are the best detectors of causation**
- 📄 **Causal mapping is part of the qualitative branch of the new causal revolution**
- 📄 **Wise as folk**
- 📄 **Causal mapping differs from related approaches - epistemic, less predictive, unsophisticated, many links, many sources, unclear boundaries**
- 📄 **Causal mapping has three tasks – gathering, coding and analysing data**
- 📄 **Task 1 – Gathering narrative data**
- 📄 **Task 2 – Coding causal claims as causal qualitative data analysis**
- 📄 **Task 3 – Analysing data, Answering questions**
- 📄 **Strong evidence for a link is not evidence of a strong link**
- 📄 **Causal mapping is easier if we are realist about causation**
- 📄 **Causal mapping is good at coping with messiness and complexity**
- 📄 **Granularity, generalisability and chunking are coding problems for causal mapping too**